

2026 COLLEGE FOOTBALL PREVIEW

Athlon Sports

INSIDE

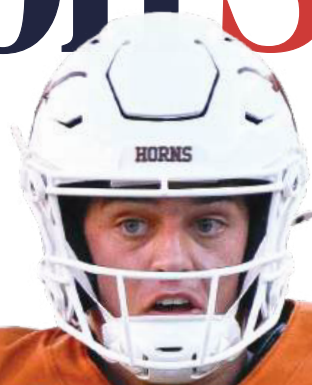
HEADING SOUTH
WHAT'S WRONG
WITH THE SEC?

THE ATHLON INTERVIEW:

CURT
CIGNETTI

TEXAS QB
ARCH MANNING

TEXAS A&M QB
MARCEL REED



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AND MORE!

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TEXAS TECH
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EDITOR'S LETTER

You might have done a double-take when you saw the provocative question we pose on the cover of this year's college football preview. And granted, it's slightly tongue-in-cheek. After all, there's really nothing "wrong" with the SEC per se.

But when you're the conference — and the region of the country — where It Just Means More™, failing to earn your perceived birthright (a national championship in college football) for three years running is a cause for concern, if not outright panic.

It's undeniable: The balance of power has shifted northward. The Big Ten is in its ascendancy, while the SEC is left wondering what just happened.

We decided to do a deep dive into this current state of affairs, and who better to assess the SEC's "decline" than longtime college football observer and scribe Dennis Dodd? In his feature story "Whatever Happened to the SEC?" on p. 46 of this year's preview, Dennis fixes his gaze on the cracks in the SEC's once-impenetrable façade. A league that hoarded national titles at a gluttonous rate is suddenly in an undeniable recession, having now missed the national championship game for three straight seasons. The league went an unconscionable 4-10 during the most recent postseason.

In the final line of his story, Dennis proposes a solution that once would have been unthinkable for SEC teams and their fan bases: Be more like Indiana. That's right, that Midwestern basketball school did something no SEC school has ever done: It went 16-0 in football. One highlight of that national championship run was a 38-3 demolition of Alabama that Paul Finebaum referred to as the SEC's "Waterloo."

Hoosiers head coach Curt Cignetti introduced himself to the wider college football world in late 2023 by saying, "I win. Google me." And he's been nothing but true to his word. The architect of the most unlikely reclamation project since Bill Snyder at Kansas State is now the sport's unexpected kingpin.

Cignetti sat down with *Athlon Sports* during a brief pause in his whirlwind offseason to discuss what he and his program can do for an encore. Another undefeated season seems unlikely, but we won't put anything past him at this point. You can find our Q&A with college football's coach of the moment on p. 42.

Change is seemingly the one constant in college football — the number of FBS teams has expanded to 138 this season with the addition of North Dakota State and Sacramento State, and another round of conference realignment has yielded the rebirth of the Pac-12.

Our very own college football savant, Steven Lassan, is charged with keeping tabs on the constant changes sweeping the sport, and his fingerprints are all over this magazine, from the predictions to the annual unit rankings to the All-America and all-conference teams. Many thanks go to Steven and to editors Kyle Wood, Mark Ross and Ben Weinrib, as well as our 97 contributing writers (I counted), who all make this publication possible. And assembling it all into a visually appealing package is our longtime creative director Matt Taliaferro. It's a team effort, and we have the best team in the business.

Enjoy the magazine, and enjoy the season.

Rob Doster

ROB DOSTER, MANAGING EDITOR



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THE ARENA

Athlon Sports

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TOP 25

BY STEVEN LASSAN

1. OHIO STATE

The Buckeyes appeared to be the team to beat for most of the '25 season. However, head coach Ryan Day's squad stumbled late with back-to-back losses to Indiana in the Big Ten Championship Game and to Miami (Fla.) in the College Football Playoff quarterfinals. That two-game losing streak is likely to fuel Ohio State in '26. Quarterback Julian Sayin should be better in his second year as the starter, and wide receiver **Jeremiah Smith** is back to dominate opposing defensive backs as arguably the top returning player in college football. Sayin and Smith will be even more dangerous if the ground attack provides a little more support under new offensive coordinator Arthur Smith. Safety Caleb Downs, linebackers Sonny Styles and Arvell Reese and defensive lineman Kayden McDonald are just a few of the top names departing a suffocating defense. However, it's hard to doubt coordinator Matt Patricia's ability to keep this unit near the top of the Big Ten this season after a stellar debut last fall. A schedule that includes road trips to Texas, Indiana and USC and a home game against Oregon won't be easy.



JOIN STEVEN LASSAN AT
ATHLONSports.com
FOR IN-DEPTH COLLEGE
FOOTBALL COVERAGE
THROUGHOUT THE SEASON



STEVE SARKISIAN (LEFT) AND KIRBY SMART

2. GEORGIA

The Bulldogs have won back-to-back SEC championships, but head coach Kirby Smart's team is looking for its first playoff win since 2022. That drought seems poised to end in '26. Smart has developed a deep roster with talent overflowing in spots. Eight starters are back on defense, including a pair of standouts in the secondary — cornerback Ellis Robinson IV and safety KJ Bolden. Sophomore Elijah Griffin is the next star game-wrecker in the defensive trenches. After a solid debut last season, quarterback Gunner Stockton aims to take the next step in '26. Running back Nate Frazier headlines one of the deepest backfields in the nation, and three returning starters form the foundation of a solid offensive line. A revamped receiving corps is arguably the team's biggest concern. However, if Smart and offensive coordinator Mike Bobo find the right mix, and the passing game generates a few more big plays in '26, Georgia can return to the top step of college football.

3. TEXAS

A year after failing to meet high expectations, the Longhorns seemingly took the right steps this offseason to erase that disappointment. Quarterback Arch Manning played his best ball down the stretch and enters his second year as the full-time starter more comfortable in head coach Steve Sarkisian's offense. Aiding Manning is an improved offensive line, along with key transfer pickups in receiver Cam Coleman (Auburn) and running backs Hollywood Smothers (NC State) and Raleek Brown (Arizona State). Defense hasn't been a major concern in Austin, but Sarkisian took a swing at transforming this unit into an elite group by hiring long-time coordinator Will Muschamp. End Colin Simmons should thrive in Muschamp's aggressive scheme, with transfer pickups at linebacker in Rasheem Biles (Pitt) and cornerback Bo Mascoe (Rutgers) plugging key voids. A Week 2 date against Ohio State is an opportunity for revenge. Late-season road trips to LSU and Texas A&M loom large for the Longhorns' hopes of an SEC title.

4. NOTRE DAME

After last year's playoff snub, the '26 season is all about revenge for the Fighting Irish. And making the postseason isn't simply the goal for Notre Dame — head coach Marcus Freeman's team has all of the ingredients to bring a national title back to South Bend. Quarterback CJ Carr navigated early ups and downs last season to emerge as one of the top signal-callers in the nation. The Fighting Irish return one of the deeper receiving corps the program has assembled in recent years, and the ground game will remain strong behind Aneayas Williams with Jeremiyah Love off to the NFL. How the line jells after a couple of players missed spring practice due to injury is the biggest concern on offense. After a rocky start, Notre Dame's defense played significantly better down the stretch. No opponent scored more than 24 points over the final nine games. Freeman's team could be favored in all 12 of its regular-season contests.



JOSH HOOVER

5. INDIANA

The Hoosiers lost a handful of key players from last season's championship squad, but head coach Curt Cignetti's team isn't going anywhere. Both sides of the ball found reinforcements in the portal, with quarterback Josh Hoover (TCU) and receiver Nick Marsh (Michigan State) among the players poised for the biggest impact.



6. OREGON

All of the pieces are in place for Oregon to win its first national title. Quarterback Dante Moore and a group of key defenders all passed on the NFL for one more season in Eugene. A road trip to Ohio State in November could decide a spot in the Big Ten Championship Game.

DANTE MOORE

7. MIAMI (FLA.)

Head coach Mario Cristobal's team is loaded for another run at the national title after landing Duke transfer quarterback Darian Mensah to pair with some of the ACC's top skill talent in running back Mark Fletcher Jr. and receiver Malachi Toney. Six starters return on a defense that led the ACC in fewest points per game allowed (14.8).



MARK FLETCHER JR.

8. OKLAHOMA

The Sooners have a few holes to plug on defense, but head coach Brent Venables will find a way to keep this unit near the top of the SEC. An improved supporting cast and offensive line should help quarterback John Mateer take a step forward after an up-and-down (and injury-plagued) debut in Norman last year.

9. TEXAS A&M

After a first-round playoff exit last season, the Aggies have their sights set on a deeper run in '26. To accomplish that, quarterback Marcel Reed has to elevate his play under first-time play-caller Holmon Wiggins. A revamped offensive line is also a concern, but head coach Mike Elko's defense will be strong once again.

10. LSU

New head coach Lane Kiffin won't get much of a honeymoon period in Baton Rouge. With a massive investment in the new staff and player acquisition and retention, the expectation is for the Bayou Bengals to make the playoff. Quarterback Sam Leavitt's health is one of the SEC's top X-factors in '26.



LANE KIFFIN

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: CHRIS PIETSCH/THE REGISTER-GUARD; MATTHEW HINTON-IMAGN IMAGES; MARK J. REBILAS-IMAGN IMAGES



TRINIDAD CHAMBLISS

11. OLE MISS

Head coach Pete Golding is already off to a strong start in Oxford thanks to two victories in the College Football Playoff. Golding's success extended off the field as well, as the Rebels retained star quarterback Trinidad Chambliss and running back Kewan Lacy. A standout transfer portal haul should help the defense improve in '26.

12. TEXAS TECH

The Red Raiders are heavy favorites to win the Big 12 once again. However, the uncertainty surrounding quarterback Brendan Sorsby's status narrowed the gap to the rest of the conference. Head coach Joey McGuire's team needs to rely on a deep backfield and standout defense until potential new starting quarterback Will Hammond is 100% after a '25 knee injury.

13. MICHIGAN

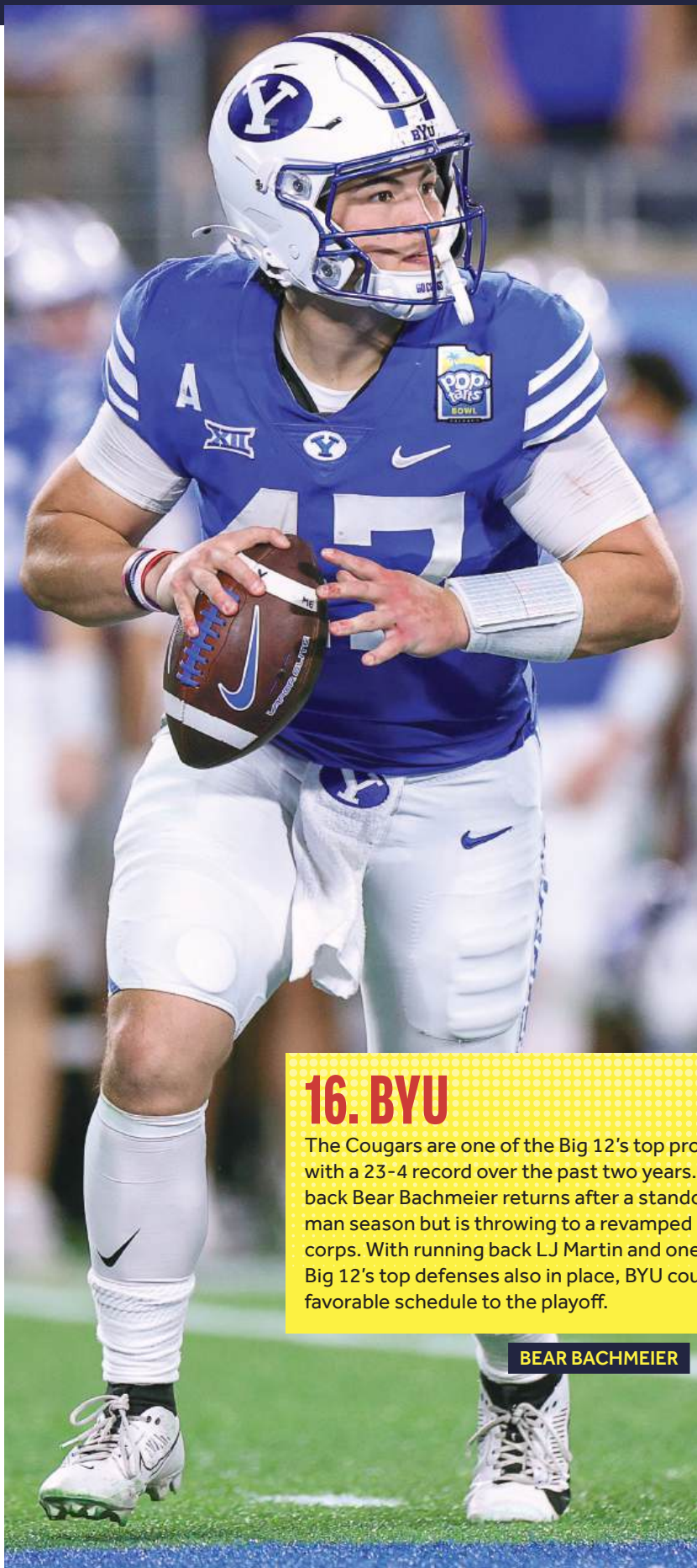
New head coach Kyle Whittingham inherits a team poised to contend for the playoff. The Wolverines will be strong once again on defense, but the development of dynamic sophomore quarterback Bryce Underwood looms large against a schedule that includes matchups against Oklahoma, Indiana, Oregon and Ohio State. Jordan Marshall and true freshman Savion Hiter form one of the top backfield tandems in the nation.

14. USC

Quarterback Jayden Maiava and an experienced offensive line are back on a high-powered offense, but standout receivers Makai Lemon and Ja'Kobi Lane must be replaced. Hopes of a College Football Playoff run hinge on how far new coordinator Gary Patterson can improve the defense.

15. ALABAMA

The Crimson Tide have more question marks than usual, with only five returning starters. But head coach Kalen DeBoer's team has a favorable schedule and could once again make the College Football Playoff if the ground game improves behind a revamped offensive line. Austin Mack and Keelon Russell are expected to continue their quarterback battle into the fall.



16. BYU

The Cougars are one of the Big 12's top programs, with a 23-4 record over the past two years. Quarterback Bear Bachmeier returns after a standout freshman season but is throwing to a revamped receiving corps. With running back LJ Martin and one of the Big 12's top defenses also in place, BYU could ride a favorable schedule to the playoff.

BEAR BACHMEIER



JEDD FISCH

17. WASHINGTON

If the Huskies are going to take the next step after a nine-win campaign in 2025, head coach Jedd Fisch must restock the supporting cast around quarterback Demond Williams Jr. and reload a defense that returns only four starters. The schedule includes tough road trips to USC and Oregon.

18. PENN STATE

After last year's disappointing seven-win season, expectations are significantly lower this fall in Happy Valley. New head coach Matt Campbell brought in 40 transfers, with quarterback Rocco Becht among those following him from Iowa State. The schedule breaks in Penn State's favor by missing Ohio State, Oregon and Indiana.

19. HOUSTON

The Cougars improved their win total by six games from 2024 to '25. Head coach Willie Fritz's squad has its sights set on another step forward into Big 12 title contention, especially with quarterback Conner Weigman returning and Oregon transfer running back Makhi Hughes solidifying the ground game.

20. UTAH

New head coach Morgan Scalley should find a way to keep Utah's defense among the best in the Big 12.

How the Utes rebuild up front and transition to new offensive coordinator Kevin McGiven will decide how high this team climbs in the conference. The dynamic quarterback duo of Devon Dampier and Byrd Ficklin leads the way.

FROM LEFT: NATHAN RAY/SEEBECK-IMAGN IMAGES; JULIA HANSEN/IOWA CITY PRESS-CIT



21. TENNESSEE

Head coach Josh Heupel took steps to fix Tennessee's struggling defense by hiring veteran coordinator Jim Knowles and investing heavily in impact transfers. The Volunteers are breaking in a new quarterback; however, Heupel's team returns some of the SEC's top skill talent in running back DeSean Bishop and receiver Braylon Staley to go with an experienced offensive line.

DeSEAN BISHOP

22. SMU

The Mustangs are 14-2 in ACC play since joining the league in '24. Head coach Rhett Lashlee's squad could be the biggest threat to Miami (Fla.) with quarterback Kevin Jennings piloting a high-powered offense featuring new faces from the portal at the skill spots. New defensive play-caller Maurice Crum Jr. has holes to fill on a defense that held conference opponents to 17.8 points per game last year.

23. LOUISVILLE

After an injury-plagued season, along with a brief entry into the portal, running back Isaac Brown is back to power the Cardinals' ACC title hopes. Head coach Jeff Brohm also hopes Ohio State transfer Lincoln Kienholz provides needed consistency and big-play ability at quarterback. Edge rusher Clev Lubin headlines five returning starters on defense.

24. BOISE STATE

Behind quarterback Maddux Madsen and a standout one-two punch at running back in Dylan Riley and Sire Gaines, Boise State is a heavy favorite to win the Pac-12 and take the top spot among Group of 6 conferences in the playoff rankings. A Week 1 trip to Oregon is a huge opportunity for head coach Spencer Danielson's team.



KIRK FERENTZ

25. IOWA

The Hawkeyes return only six starters and have several holes to fill from a standout '25 defense. However, head coach Kirk Ferentz and his staff usually find the right answers. Also, a rock-solid offensive line and deep stable of running backs should help ease the transition to a new quarterback.



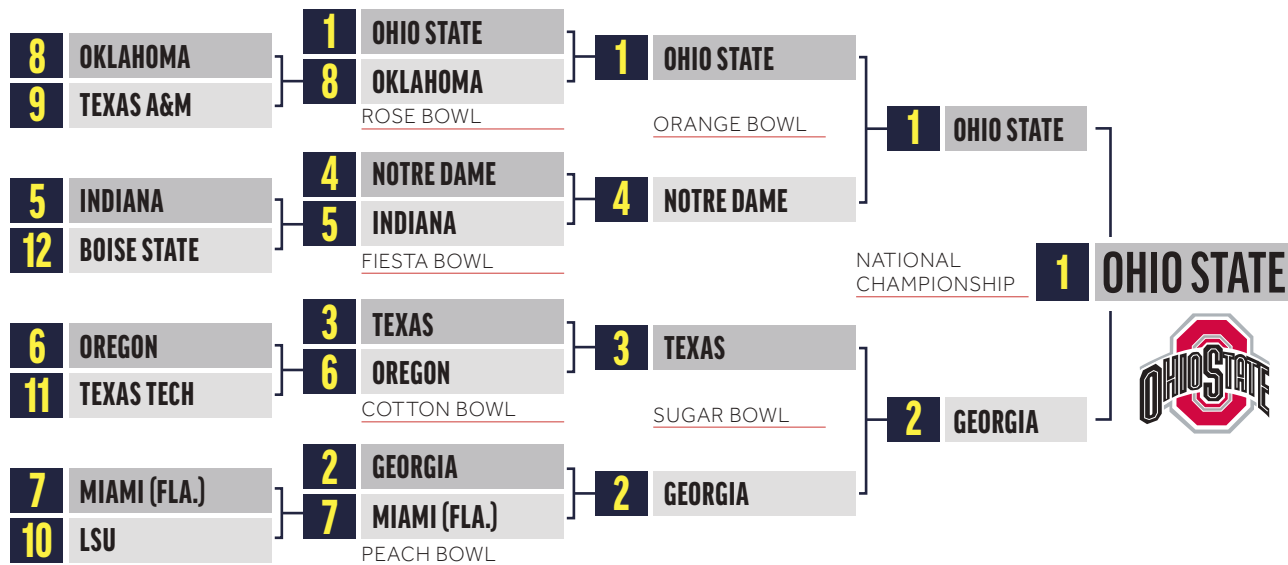
2026

PLAYOFF BRACKET

FIRST ROUND

QUARTERFINALS

SEMIFINALS



FIRST-ROUND BYES:

OHIO STATE, GEORGIA, TEXAS, NOTRE DAME

FROM PAGE 11

26. Florida
27. Clemson
28. South Carolina
29. Missouri
30. Virginia Tech
31. Kansas State
32. Arizona
33. Illinois
34. Auburn
35. Arizona State
36. Oklahoma State
37. TCU
38. Nebraska
39. Virginia
40. Pitt
41. Georgia Tech
42. Minnesota
43. UCLA
44. Mississippi State
45. Vanderbilt
46. NC State
47. California
48. Florida State
49. Kentucky
50. West Virginia
51. Arkansas
52. Kansas
53. Wake Forest

54. Duke
55. Wisconsin
56. North Carolina
57. Northwestern
58. Maryland
59. UNLV
60. Navy
61. New Mexico
62. Baylor
63. Cincinnati
64. Colorado
65. UCF
66. Memphis
67. San Diego State
68. Fresno State
69. Rutgers
70. Iowa State
71. Syracuse
72. Michigan State
73. UTSA
74. Army
75. East Carolina
76. South Florida
77. Hawai'i
78. North Dakota State
79. Tulane
80. Air Force
81. Troy

82. James Madison
83. Boston College
84. Stanford
85. Purdue
86. Miami (Ohio)
87. Western Michigan
88. Washington State
89. WKU
90. Temple
91. Liberty
92. Utah State
93. Texas State
94. Old Dominion
95. Marshall
96. Florida Atlantic
97. Colorado State
98. Central Michigan
99. Toledo
100. Arkansas State
101. Oregon State
102. Georgia Southern
103. UConn
104. Louisiana Tech
105. Kennesaw State
106. Jacksonville State
107. Delaware
108. Tulsa
109. North Texas

110. Wyoming
111. Ohio
112. FIU
113. Nevada
114. Louisiana
115. South Alabama
116. San José State
117. Appalachian State
118. Buffalo
119. Coastal Carolina
120. Rice
121. UAB
122. Bowling Green
123. Southern Miss
124. Eastern Michigan
125. Akron
126. Kent State
127. Charlotte
128. Missouri State
129. New Mexico State
130. UTEP
131. ULM
132. Georgia State
133. Middle Tennessee
134. Northern Illinois
135. Ball State
136. Sacramento State
137. Sam Houston
138. UMass

2026

BOWL PROJECTIONS

POINSETTIA BOWL

Pac-12 vs. Mountain West
San Diego State vs. UNLV

SALUTE TO VETERANS

MAC vs. Sun Belt
Delaware* vs. Georgia Southern

CURE

Sun Belt vs. American/CUSA/MAC
East Carolina* vs. Western Michigan

68 VENTURES

Sun Belt vs. American/CUSA/MAC
Arkansas State vs. Jacksonville State

XBOX

American/CUSA/MAC/Sun Belt
Old Dominion vs. Utah State*

MYRTLE BEACH

Sun Belt vs. American/CUSA/MAC
Marshall vs. Liberty

GASPARILLA

ACC vs. SEC/American
Georgia Tech vs. Memphis

FAMOUS IDAHO POTATO

Mountain West vs. MAC
North Dakota State vs. Toledo

BOCA RATON

American/CUSA/MAC/Sun Belt
Miami (Ohio) vs. Troy

NEW ORLEANS

Conference USA vs. Sun Belt
WKU vs. James Madison

FRISCO

American/CUSA/MAC/MW/Sun Belt
Louisiana Tech vs. Central Michigan

HAWAI'I

American vs. Mountain West
UCLA* vs. Hawai'i

PUERTO RICO

Pac-12 vs. Group of 6
Fresno State vs. South Florida

RATE

Big 12 vs. Big Ten
TCU vs. Illinois

FIRST RESPONDER

Big 12/American/CUSA/ACC
Cal vs. Washington State*

MILITARY

ACC vs. American
Wake Forest vs. Temple

PINSTRIPE

ACC vs. Big Ten
Pitt vs. Minnesota

FENWAY

ACC vs. American
NC State vs. Army

POP-TARTS

ACC vs. Big 12
Louisville vs. Houston

ARIZONA

MAC vs. Mountain West
Ohio vs. Air Force

NEW MEXICO

Mountain West vs. American
New Mexico vs. UTSA

GATOR

SEC vs. ACC
Alabama vs. SMU

TEXAS

SEC vs. Big 12
Missouri vs. Oklahoma State

BIRMINGHAM

SEC vs. ACC
Vanderbilt vs. Tulane*

INDEPENDENCE

Big 12 vs. Conference USA
West Virginia vs. Kennesaw State

MUSIC CITY

SEC vs. Big Ten
South Carolina vs. Nebraska

ALAMO

Big 12 vs. Pac-12
BYU vs. USC*

RELIAQUEST

SEC vs. Big Ten
Florida vs. Penn State

SUN

ACC vs. Pac-12
Virginia vs. Utah*

CITRUS

SEC vs. Big Ten
Ole Miss vs. Michigan

LAS VEGAS

Big Ten vs. Pac-12
Iowa vs. Arizona*

ARMED FORCES

Big 12 vs. American/CUSA
Arizona State vs. Navy

LIBERTY

Big 12 vs. SEC
Kansas State vs. Auburn

DUKE'S MAYO

ACC vs. SEC
Virginia Tech vs. Tennessee

HOLIDAY

ACC vs. Pac-12
Clemson vs. Washington*

COLLEGE FOOTBALL PLAYOFF

FIRST ROUND

No. 5 Indiana vs. No. 12 Boise State
No. 6 Oregon vs. No. 11 Texas Tech
No. 7 Miami (Fla.) vs. No. 10 LSU
No. 8 Oklahoma vs. No. 9 Texas A&M

QUARTERFINALS

Fiesta Bowl
No. 4 Notre Dame vs. No. 5 Indiana
Cotton Bowl
No. 3 Texas vs. No. 6 Oregon
Peach Bowl
No. 2 Georgia vs. No. 7 Miami (Fla.)
Rose Bowl
No. 1 Ohio State vs. No. 8 Oklahoma

SEMIFINALS

Orange Bowl
No. 1 Ohio State vs. No. 4 Notre Dame
Sugar Bowl
No. 2 Georgia vs. No. 3 Texas

NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIP

No. 1 Ohio State vs. No. 2 Georgia

*Indicates at-large team selected with conference unable to fill allotted bowl spots.



2026

ALL-AMERICA



ARCH MANNING • QB • TEXAS

1ST TEAM

OFFENSE

QB	ARCH MANNING TEXAS	
RB	AHMAD HARDY MISSOURI	
RB	KEWAN LACY OLE MISS	
AP	MALACHI TONEY MIAMI (FLA.)	
WR	JEREMIAH SMITH OHIO STATE	
WR	CAM COLEMAN TEXAS	
WR	DUCE ROBINSON FLORIDA STATE	
TE	TREY'DEZ GREEN LSU	
C	IAPANI LALOULU OREGON	
OL	CARTER SMITH INDIANA	
OL	TREVOR GOOSBY TEXAS	
OL	KADE PIEPER IOWA	
OL	CAYDEN GREEN MISSOURI	

MATT PENDLETON-IMAGINAGES



LEONARD MOORE • CB • NOTRE DAME



ROLIJAH HARDY • LB • INDIANA

DEFENSE

DL	COLIN SIMMONS TEXAS	
DL	JOHN HENRY DALEY MICHIGAN	
DL	TYRIQUE TUCKER INDIANA	
DL	A'MAURI WASHINGTON OREGON	
LB	XAVIER ATKINS AUBURN	
LB	WHIT WEEKS LSU	
LB	RASHEEM BILES TEXAS	
LB	ROLIJAH HARDY INDIANA	
CB	LEONARD MOORE NOTRE DAME	
CB	ELLIS ROBINSON IV GEORGIA	
S	KJ BOLDEN GEORGIA	
S	BRAY HUBBARD ALABAMA	

SPECIALISTS

K	TATE SANDELL OKLAHOMA	
P	EVAN CRENSHAW TROY	
KR	DA'REALYST CLARK KENT STATE	
PR	RYAN NIBLETT TEXAS	



TATE SANDELL • K • OKLAHOMA

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: MICHAEL CATERINA-IMAGN IMAGES; MARK J. REBILAS-IMAGN IMAGES; BRYAN TERRY/THE OKLAHOMAN

2ND TEAM

OFFENSE

QB	JULIAN SAYIN OHIO STATE	
RB	JADAN BAUGH FLORIDA	
RB	ISAAC BROWN LOUISVILLE	
AP	CALEB HAWKINS OKLAHOMA STATE	
WR	MARIO CRAVER TEXAS A&M	
WR	CHARLIE BECKER INDIANA	
WR	KJ DUFF RUTGERS	
TE	JAMARI JOHNSON OREGON	
C	DREW BOBO GEORGIA	
OL	ANTHONIE KNAPP NOTRE DAME	
OL	AUSTIN SIERVELD OHIO STATE	
OL	TREVOR LAUCK IOWA	
OL	EVAN TENGESDAHL CINCINNATI	



ISAAC BROWN • RB • LOUISVILLE

DEFENSE

DL	DAVID STONE OKLAHOMA	
DL	A.J. HOLMES JR. TEXAS TECH	
DL	ANTHONY SMITH MINNESOTA	
DL	DYLAN STEWART SOUTH CAROLINA	
LB	TEITUM TUIOTI OREGON	
LB	KIP LEWIS OKLAHOMA	
LB	ISAIAH JONES INDIANA	
LB	RAYLEN WILSON GEORGIA	
CB	BRICE POLLOCK TEXAS TECH	
CB	KELLEY JONES MISSISSIPPI STATE	
S	MARCUS RATCLIFFE TEXAS A&M	
S	AMARE FERRELL INDIANA	

SPECIALISTS

K	LUCAS CARNEIRO OLE MISS	
P	PALMER WILLIAMS BAYLOR	
KR	KOI PERICH OREGON	
PR	VICARI SWAIN SOUTH CAROLINA	



3RD TEAM

OFFENSE

QB	DANTE MOORE OREGON	
RB	LJ MARTIN BYU	
RB	MARK FLETCHER JR. MIAMI (FLA.)	
AP	ANTWAN RAYMOND RUTGERS	
WR	RYAN COLEMAN-WILLIAMS ALABAMA	
WR	AMARE THOMAS HOUSTON	
WR	WYATT YOUNG OKLAHOMA STATE	
TE	TERRANCE CARTER JR. TEXAS TECH	
C	BRUCE MITCHELL BYU	
OL	SHADRE HURST HOUSTON	
OL	JORDAN SEATON LSU	
OL	WENDELL MOE JR. TENNESSEE	
OL	EARNEST GREENE III GEORGIA	

DEFENSE

DL	MATAYO UIAGALELEI OREGON	
DL	CLEV LUBIN LOUISVILLE	
DL	TAYLOR WEIN OKLAHOMA	
DL	PRINCEWILL UMANMIELEN LSU	
LB	SAMMY BROWN CLEMSON	
LB	KYNGSTONN VILIAMU-ASA NOTRE DAME	
LB	BEN ROBERTS TEXAS TECH	
LB	SUNTARINE PERKINS OLE MISS	
CB	BRANDON FINNEY JR. OREGON	
CB	DJ PICKETT LSU	
S	KEON SABB ALABAMA	
S	KOI PERICH OREGON	

SPECIALISTS

K	AIDAN BIRR GEORGIA TECH	
P	GRAYSON MILLER OKLAHOMA	
KR	RAYSHAWN PLEASANT AUBURN	
PR	MALACHI TONEY MIAMI (FLA.)	



SUNTARINE PERKINS • LB • OLE MISS



26TH ANNUAL

UNIT RANKINGS

ACC

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Boston College	16	14	16	17	17	17	16
Cal	4	12	5	12	15	16	13
Clemson	9	6	2	6	2	2	3
Duke	15	5	10	11	14	14	15
Florida State	12	4	3	10	7	7	8
Georgia Tech	13	3	13	4	12	8	14
Louisville	8	2	7	5	4	1	2
Miami (Fla.)	1	1	1	1	1	3	1
North Carolina	14	13	15	15	8	15	12
NC State	3	8	9	8	11	13	10
Pitt	6	11	11	7	3	6	5
SMU	2	11	4	2	9	4	9
Stanford	17	15	17	14	16	9	17
Syracuse	7	17	14	13	13	12	11
Virginia	10	7	8	3	6	5	4
Virginia Tech	5	10	6	9	10	11	6
Wake Forest	11	16	12	16	5	10	7

AMERICAN

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Army	2	11	12	1	3	9	8
Charlotte	13	14	11	14	14	11	13
East Carolina	7	4	4	7	5	5	4
Florida Atlantic	3	13	2	9	9	8	9
Memphis	5	10	6	6	1	1	1
Navy	4	12	13	2	7	2	6
North Texas	11	3	7	11	11	12	11
Rice	14	9	14	13	12	14	12
South Florida	6	7	3	3	2	3	3
Temple	12	8	5	4	10	6	10
Tulane	9	1	8	8	4	4	2
Tulsa	8	6	9	12	8	10	5
UAB	10	5	10	10	13	13	14
UTSA	1	2	1	5	6	7	7



MALACHI TONEY • WR • MIAMI (FLA.)



DAVID AMADOR II • WR • UTSA

FROM TOP: MARK J. REBILAS-IMAGN IMAGES; DANNY WILD-IMAGN IMAGES

BIG 12

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Arizona	1	11	7	7	7	4	9
Arizona State	12	9	3	10	6	6	10
Baylor	7	7	12	13	14	13	11
BYU	4	3	10	3	2	2	2
Cincinnati	15	14	14	1	13	11	14
Colorado	11	16	5	16	16	16	15
Houston	5	6	4	4	5	3	3
Iowa State	13	15	15	15	10	9	12
Kansas	16	10	11	8	8	7	8
Kansas State	6	8	6	9	9	8	6
Oklahoma State	2	2	2	11	11	12	13
TCU	9	12	8	5	3	10	7
Texas Tech	8	1	1	2	1	1	1
UCF	10	13	13	14	15	15	5
Utah	3	4	9	6	4	5	4
West Virginia	14	5	16	12	12	14	16



A.J. HOLMES JR. • DL • TEXAS TECH

BIG TEN

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Illinois	10	10	10	10	13	14	11
Indiana	3	4	3	1	2	1	3
Iowa	16	9	16	5	9	9	6
Maryland	9	17	15	13	11	7	12
Michigan	6	3	5	4	4	10	4
Michigan State	15	16	17	17	17	15	16
Minnesota	11	8	12	11	6	12	13
Nebraska	12	15	8	6	10	11	8
Northwestern	14	11	14	16	12	13	10
Ohio State	2	1	1	2	3	3	2
Oregon	1	2	2	3	1	2	1
Penn State	7	7	6	9	7	4	5
Purdue	18	18	18	18	18	18	18
Rutgers	17	6	9	15	16	16	17
UCLA	8	13	11	12	15	17	14
USC	4	5	4	7	5	8	7
Washington	5	12	7	8	8	5	9
Wisconsin	13	14	13	14	14	6	15



DANTE MOORE • QB • OREGON

CUSA

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Delaware	1	2	1	2	5	3	5
FIU	7	5	4	6	6	6	3
Jacksonville State	3	8	7	3	1	1	1
Kennesaw State	6	3	5	5	3	2	4
Liberty	4	1	3	1	2	4	6
Middle Tennessee	5	9	10	8	8	9	8
Missouri State	9	7	6	9	9	8	9
New Mexico State	8	10	8	7	7	5	7
Sam Houston	10	6	9	10	10	10	10
WKU	2	4	2	4	4	7	2

MAC

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Akron	5	4	3	6	6	12	9
Ball State	13	12	13	7	13	13	12
Bowling Green	8	6	11	11	7	6	7
Buffalo	12	10	9	10	8	7	3
Central Michigan	10	5	7	3	5	10	6
Eastern Michigan	3	8	2	5	9	8	5
Kent State	4	11	6	8	10	11	10
Miami (Ohio)	9	3	4	1	1	1	2
Ohio	7	7	8	9	4	3	8
Sacramento State	6	9	10	13	11	9	13
Toledo	2	2	1	4	3	2	4
UMass	11	13	12	12	12	4	11
Western Michigan	1	1	5	2	2	5	1

MWC

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Air Force	2	3	10	6	7	2	5
Hawai'i	1	10	1	7	6	6	7
Nevada	7	7	6	4	5	5	6
New Mexico	4	2	3	3	2	1	1
North Dakota St.	5	5	5	1	1	3	2
Northern Illinois	10	6	8	9	10	10	10
San José State	9	9	4	8	9	9	9
UNLV	3	1	2	2	3	4	4
UTEP	8	8	7	10	8	8	8
Wyoming	6	4	9	5	4	7	3



SEAN WILSON • WR • DELAWARE



ANDREW LOWRY • OL • MIAMI (OHIO)



MERCURY SWAIM • LB • TAVIAN COMBS • S • NEW MEXICO

FROM TOP: WILLIAM BRETZGER-DELAWARE NEWS; J. MARK J. REBILAS-IMAGNI IMAGES (2)



PAC-12

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Boise State	1	1	2	1	1	1	1
Colorado State	7	4	8	8	8	7	8
Fresno State	8	3	5	2	2	3	2
Oregon State	4	7	7	6	7	5	7
San Diego State	3	2	4	3	3	2	3
Texas State	2	5	1	7	6	6	5
Utah State	6	6	6	4	4	4	4
Washington State	5	8	3	5	5	8	6

SEC

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Alabama	9	14	4	12	8	8	2
Arkansas	16	15	13	11	16	16	16
Auburn	5	9	12	14	12	7	13
Florida	12	5	3	9	9	11	9
Georgia	3	2	9	1	3	1	1
Kentucky	14	16	16	10	13	15	15
LSU	4	6	7	7	5	2	4
Miss. State	11	10	14	16	15	14	11
Missouri	10	1	10	6	11	9	12
Oklahoma	8	11	5	4	2	3	3
Ole Miss	2	3	8	8	6	6	8
South Carolina	6	13	11	13	10	12	10
Tennessee	13	7	6	3	7	5	7
Texas	1	4	1	2	1	4	6
Texas A&M	7	8	2	5	4	10	5
Vanderbilt	15	12	15	15	14	13	14

SUN BELT

	QB	RB	WR	OL	DL	LB	DB
Appalachian State	11	5	7	9	10	5	10
Arkansas State	10	2	3	4	8	10	3
Coastal Carolina	12	11	8	14	13	7	7
Georgia Southern	4	8	1	8	4	4	4
Georgia State	7	14	11	7	14	14	14
James Madison	3	1	2	2	2	3	2
Louisiana	9	9	10	1	5	12	11
Louisiana Tech	5	13	13	5	3	1	8
Marshall	2	6	4	3	9	6	6
Old Dominion	6	3	6	11	1	2	1
South Alabama	8	4	9	10	7	8	9
Southern Miss	13	10	12	12	11	13	12
Troy	1	7	5	6	6	11	5
ULM	14	12	14	13	12	9	13

NATIONAL
UNIT RANKINGS

QUARTERBACKS

- | | |
|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. Texas | 6. Miami (Fla.) |
| 2. Oregon | 7. Georgia |
| 3. Ohio State | 8. Indiana |
| 4. Notre Dame | 9. USC |
| 5. Ole Miss | 10. LSU |

RUNNING BACKS

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| 1. Missouri | 6. Texas |
| 2. Georgia | 7. Texas Tech |
| 3. Ole Miss | 8. Ohio State |
| 4. Miami (Fla.) | 9. Oregon |
| 5. Louisville | 10. Michigan |

WIDE RECEIVERS

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| 1. Ohio State | 6. Clemson |
| 2. Texas | 7. Texas A&M |
| 3. Miami (Fla.) | 8. Texas Tech |
| 4. Oregon | 9. Notre Dame |
| 5. Indiana | 10. Florida |

OFFENSIVE LINE

- | | |
|---------------|----------------|
| 1. Notre Dame | 6. Oregon |
| 2. Georgia | 7. Michigan |
| 3. Indiana | 8. Iowa |
| 4. Ohio State | 9. Tennessee |
| 5. Texas | 10. Cincinnati |

DEFENSIVE LINE

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| 1. Oregon | 6. Oklahoma |
| 2. Notre Dame | 7. Ohio State |
| 3. Miami (Fla.) | 8. Georgia |
| 4. Indiana | 9. Michigan |
| 5. Texas | 10. Texas Tech |

LINEBACKERS

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| 1. Georgia | 6. Oklahoma |
| 2. Notre Dame | 7. Texas |
| 3. Indiana | 8. Texas Tech |
| 4. LSU | 9. Tennessee |
| 5. Oregon | 10. BYU |

DEFENSIVE BACKS

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------|
| 1. Notre Dame | 6. Georgia |
| 2. Oregon | 7. Alabama |
| 3. Miami (Fla.) | 8. Oklahoma |
| 4. Ohio State | 9. LSU |
| 5. Indiana | 10. Michigan |